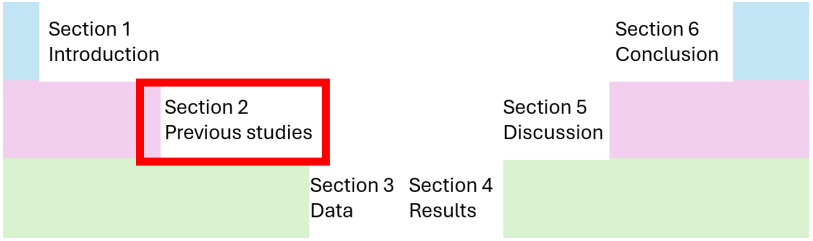
Class 4

Academic reading 4: Previous literature

Corpus research 3: Tagging 3



A third analysis of the *be* + *en*, which is very popular among L2 researchers, assumes that an underlying cause of this structure is a nontarget lexical causativization (e.g., Yip, 1994, 1995; Balcom, 1995, 1997; Hirakawa, 1995; Shomura, 1996; Montrul, 1997: 136–140, 1999; Ju, 2000). According to this analysis, L2 learners first create a nonce causative verb by a nontarget lexical process which adds a causer of the event, as an external argument (x), to the original argument structure of a nonalternating unaccusative verb. The nonce verb is then passivized through the suppression of the external argument (x = %) before it is syntactically utilized (Balcom, 1995; 1997). The changes in argument structure through the two-stage process are shown in (19):

19) Unaccusative argument structure: (ø <y>)
↓ ⇐ * causativization: addition of x
Causative argument structure: (x <y>)
↓ ⇐ passivization: suppression of x
Passive argument structure: (x = % <y>)

Notice that the causativization account – just as the adjectival passive account – is essentially a lexical analysis because what is assumed to be nontarget is the lexical causativization rule, not the syntactic structure of the *be* + *en*. The contrast between the two is that the causativization account, but not the adjectival passive account, regards the nontarget *be* + *en* as a verbal passive. Still, this account does not necessarily contradict the fact that 'passive' unaccusative errors appear mostly in the 'short passive' form because an external argument suppressed by passivization (x = %) need not be projected into syntax, for example, as part of an agentive *by* phrase (Jaeggli, 1986; Grimshaw, 1990).

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

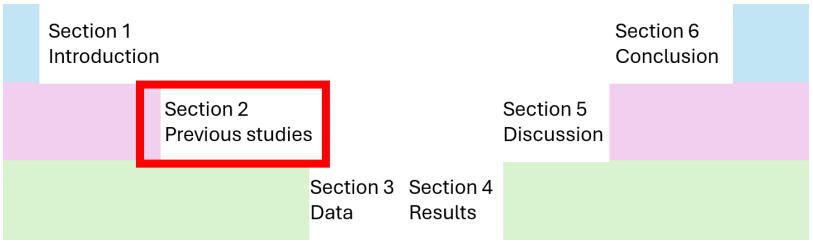
(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

Keyword: "Nontarget"
Designating or relating to a linguistic form, structure, or rule produced **in a learner's interlanguage** that deviates from the standard rules or native speaker norms of the target language. (Researchers do not want to use the adjective "wrong".)

Yip (1994, 1995)
Balcom (1995, 1997)
Hirakawa (1995)
Shomura (1996)
Montrul (1997, 1999)
Ju (2000)



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Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

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(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

Yip (1994, 1995)
Balcom (1995, 1997)
Hirakawa (1995)
Shomura (1996)
Montrul (1997, 1999)
Ju (2000)

1) Proposal

(Step 1) Morphology

a. **Lexical Causativization**

(i) The vase broke (vi) .

⇓

(ii) John broke (vt) the vase.

b. **Nontarget Lexical Causativization**

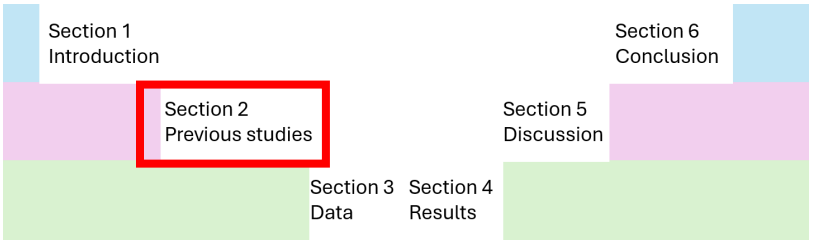
(i) Leaves fell (vi) .

⇓

(ii)*The wind fell (vt) leaves.

(Step 2) Syntax ⇓

(iii)*Leaves were fallen.



The two most critical assumptions behind the causativization analysis of 'passive' unaccusatives are:

20) a. Nonalternating unaccusative verbs are causativized in IL English.
b. 'Passive' unaccusatives are genuine verbal passives.

Let us consider each of these in turn. First, the fact that (20a) is correct is supported with both production and judgement data. For example, Rutherford (1987) notes the nontarget causative errors based on nonalternating unaccusatives such as the following.

21) a. * The shortage of fuels occurred the need for economical engine.
b. * This construction will progress my country.

Moreover, Montrul (1997; 1999) provides extensive evidence for this kind of causativization error from a series of experimental studies that involve L1 speakers of English, Spanish and Turkish learning each other's languages. Thus, there is little doubt that the nontarget lexical causativization in question does exist in L2 English (and possibly in other kinds of L2 acquisition as well).

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

Yip (1994, 1995)
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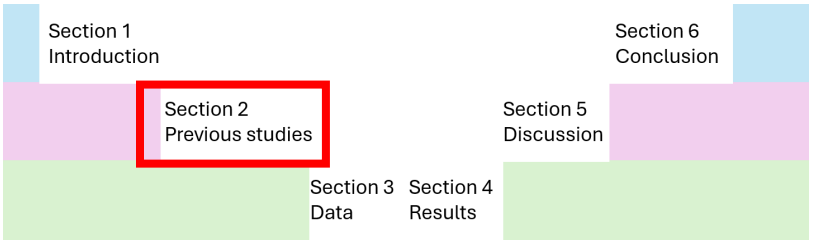
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Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

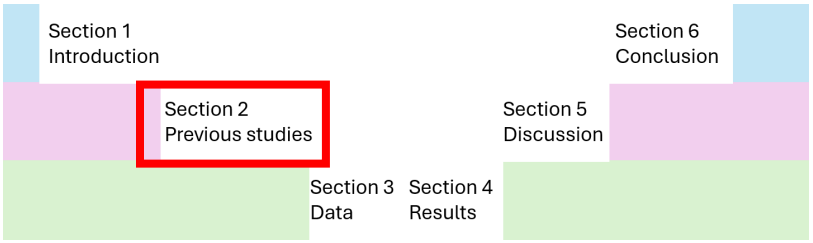
(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

Yip (1994, 1995)
Balcom (1995, 1997)
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Ju (2000)

1) Proposal

2) Observation



The two most critical assumptions behind the causativization analysis of 'passive' unaccusatives are:

20) a. Nonalternating unaccusative verbs are causativized in IL English.
b. 'Passive' unaccusatives are genuine verbal passives.

However, there are a couple of issues that need to be addressed before the causativization account is wholeheartedly adopted as an explanation of the 'passive' unaccusative phenomenon. For example, we should examine how often such nontarget causatives appear in IL English, especially in proportion to 'passive' unaccusatives. We should also ask whether all the unaccusative verbs that appear in the 'passive' unaccusative structure are equally susceptible to such lexical innovation. Consider, for instance, the likelihood of stative and achievement verbs such as *exist* and *arrive* undergoing this causativization. According to Rappaport Hovav and Levin (1998), the reason why these verbs resist causativization in the target English is that, unlike accomplishment verbs such as *break*, their event structures lack a causing subevent. Does this assumption also apply to L2 English? If the answer turns out to be positive, the causativization analysis of 'passive' unaccusatives will face a problem because 'passive' errors with these verbs do appear in nonnative English as (1d)–(1e) exemplify.

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

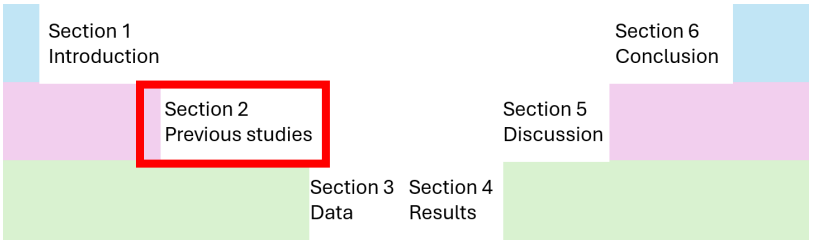
1) Proposal

2) Observation

3) Limitation

a. Frequency (ratio)

b. Stative/achievement verbs



The second assumption of (20b) also raises questions. The first is whether or not most 'passive' unaccusatives can be interpreted as semantically genuine passives. As Balcom (1995; 1997) suggests, an agentive *by* phrase and an infinitival clause as in (22a)–(22b) could shed light on this issue since they could provide evidence for the syntactic presence of a suppressed external argument in a sentence (Jaeggli, 1986; Grimshaw, 1990).

22) a. * Jane was fallen down *by Mary*.
b. * The accident was happened *to collect the insurance*.
(both from Balcom, 1997)

As noted above, however, the actual production of 'passive' unaccusatives with such strong evidence for passivization is rarely reported in published studies since most errors are in the 'short passive' structure. For example, I believe that (22b) is a hypothetical example created for illustration. Example (22a) cited with reference to Hirakawa (1994) is not a production of a learner either but an experimental sentence made for a judgement task (Hirakawa, personal communication 1999).

Without such syntactic evidence, it appears that the existence of a suppressed external argument is often assumed without question. An attempt to interpret 'passive' unaccusative errors as genuine verbal passives, however, drastically changes the meanings of the sentences. See, for instance, the following paraphrases of (1a)–(1e).[8]

23) a. The most memorable experience of my life was *made to happen* (i.e., *caused*) 15 years ago.
b. Most of people are *made to fall in love* with someone and get married.
c. My mother was *caused to die* (i.e., *killed*, *murdered*, etc.) when I was just a baby.
d. He was *made to arrive* (i.e., *brought*) early.
e. This problem is *made to exist* (i.e., *created*) for many years.

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

1) Proposal

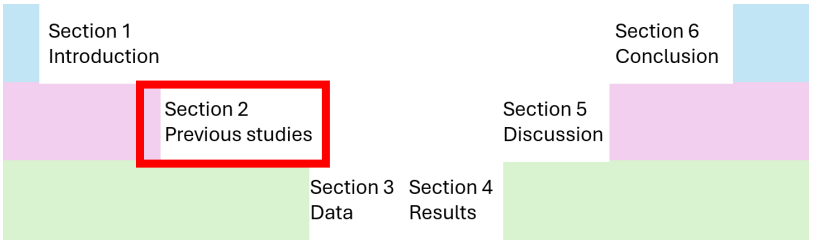
2) Observation

3) Limitation

a. Frequency (ratio)

b. Stative/achievement verbs

c. Passiveness (*by)



The oddness of semantic passivity in the above examples seems to originate from one of the following circumstances:

1) when a situation is felt to arise without an external entity's active involvement, as in *happen* (23a), *fall in love* (23b) and *die* (23c);
2) when the most plausible causative entity, if any, is the subject NP itself, as in *arrive* (23d); and
3) when the meaning of the verb is inherently stative, as in *exist* (23e).

In sum, despite its popularity, the causativization account of 'passive' unaccusatives has some serious questions to answer.

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

1) Proposal

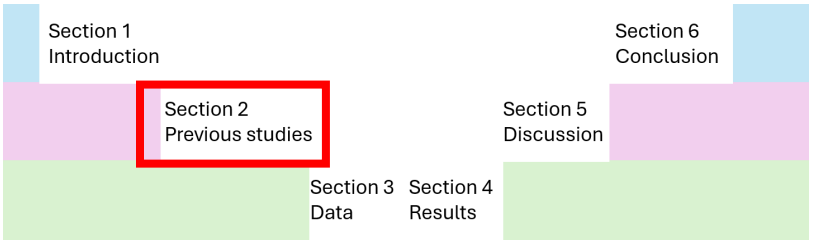
2) Observation

3) Limitation

a. Frequency (ratio)

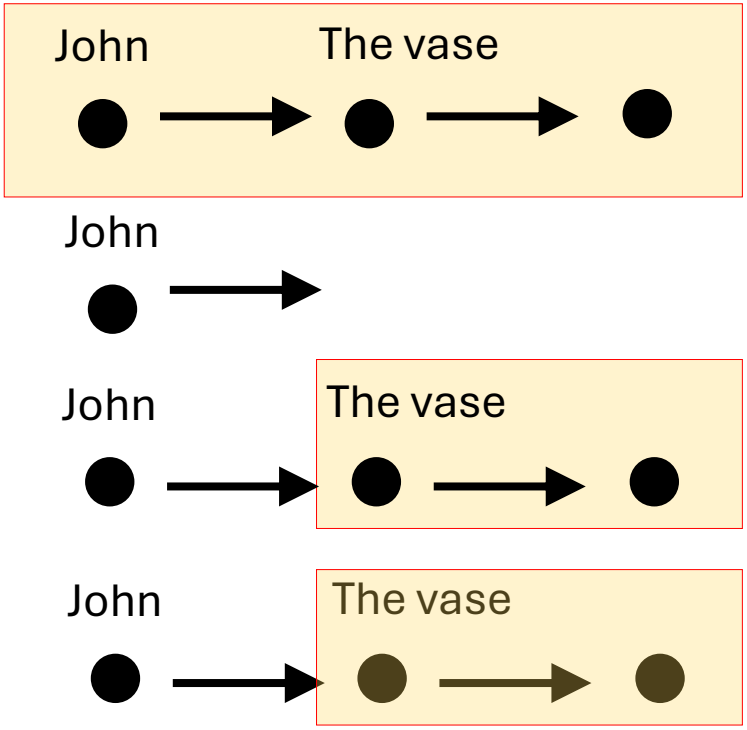
b. Stative/achievement verbs

c. Passiveness (*by)



4 Identification of the lack of a logical subject and the be + en

Still another account is suggested by Zobl (1989) who sees significance in the fact that neither passive nor unaccusative predicates require a logical subject, namely, the immediate causer of an event. Zobl speculates that L2 learners of English at a particular stage of grammatical development may canonically associate the lack of a logical subject in the verbs' argument structure with the *be* + *en* structure in syntax. Although this idea is related to the NP-movement marker analysis (see the next section) – and Zobl himself appears to treat the two as phases of a single process – they must be clearly distinguished.



Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

b. **Unergatives**

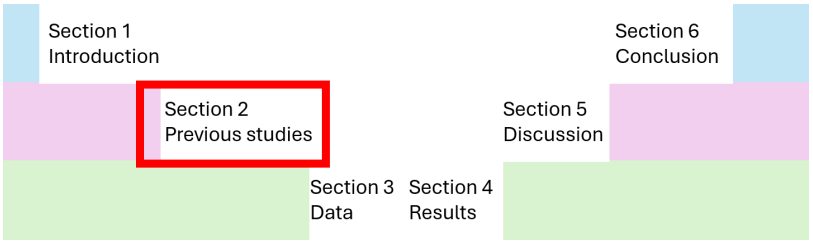
John walked
Agent

c. **Unaccusatives**

The vase broke.
Patient

d. **Passives**

The vase was broken.
Patient



Recall that the traditional analysis for the passive construction assumes object-to-subject movement in syntax as shown in (24):

24) NP_i *be* – *Ven* t_i

Remark: Two operations are independent!
1) NP movement from object to subject
2) Change in verbal form

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

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1) Proposal

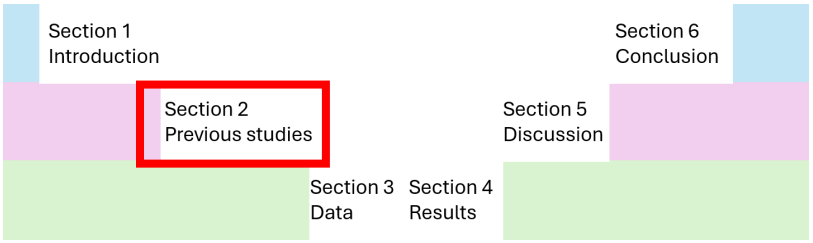
a. **Transitives**

John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

Hypothesis:
No Agent,
so *be –en*.

d. **Passives**

The vase was broken.
Patient



Recall that the traditional analysis for the passive construction assumes object-to-subject movement in syntax as shown in (24):

24) NP_i *be* – Ven t_i

The existence of an NP argument in the object position is, therefore, a prerequisite of the movement analysis. If the nontarget *be* + *en* in IL English simply indicates the lack of a logical subject as suggested by Zobl, the NP need not move as long as there is another noun that may fill the syntactic subject position: English expletives, *there* and *it*, and expletive *pro* hypothesized for languages like Italian may function as such a place holder, enabling the NP to stay in situ[9] (Davis, 1984; Burzio, 1986; Chomsky, 1986).

25) a. *there be* – Ven NP
b. *it be* – Ven NP
c. pro *be* – Ven NP

Remark: Two operations are independent!
1) NP movement from object to subject
2) Change in verbal form

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

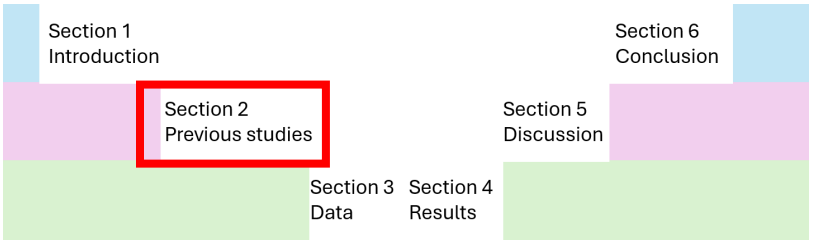
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d. **Passives**

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Patient



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b. *it be* – *Ven* NP
c. pro *be* – *Ven* NP

Remark: Two operations are independent!

1) NP movement from object to subject
2) Change in verbal form

1) Under this view, EFLs learned **morphological rule** first, before acquiring **movement**.
2) Overgeneralize the morphological rule to unaccusatives.

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

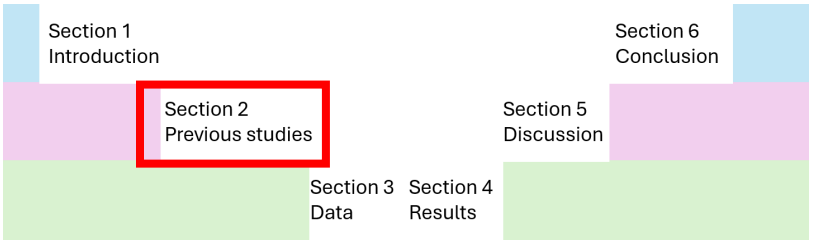
John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

d. **Passives (English)**

The vase was broken.
Patient

e. **Passives (Italian)**

pro was broken the vase.
Patient



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25) a. *there be* – *Ven* NP
b. *it be* – *Ven* NP
c. pro *be* – *Ven* NP

(i) People **know** [that SFC is great].

(ii) [That SFC is great] **is known**.

(iii) **It** **is known** [that SFC is great].

Section 2 Previous studies

Previous studies

(Approach 1) L1 Transfer of T/A + PP.

(Approach 2) Overgeneralization

(Approach 3) *Lexical causativization*

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

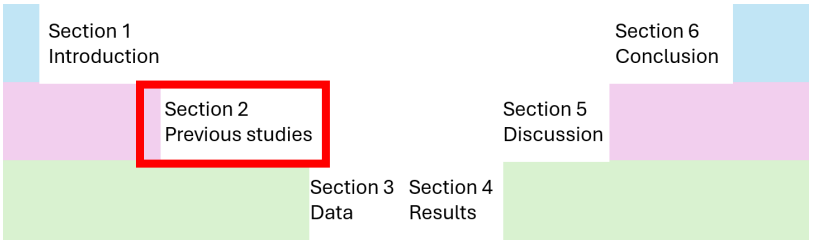
John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

d. **Passives (English)**

The vase was broken.
Patient

e. **Passives (Italian)**

pro was broken the vase.
Patient



In fact, suggesting that a structure in (25) can be found in the production of L2 learners of English, Zobl (1989: 215) cites (26) from his data:

26) * It was nearly killed all of us. (L1 Chinese)

Similar examples are independently noted in the L2 English of Spanish and Arabic native speakers by Rutherford (1989: 179).[10]

27) a. In the lake of Maracaibo was discovered the oil. (L1 Spanish)
b. In this one was placed the national school of engineering. (L1 Spanish)
c. On the walls of this monument are written the names of the victories of Napoleon's battles. (L1 Arabic)

Section 2 Previous studies

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

d. **Passives (English)**

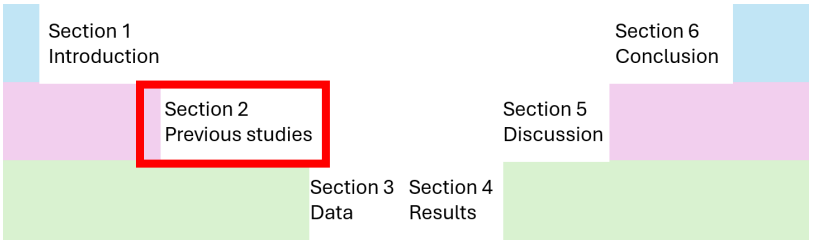
The vase was broken.
Patient

e. **Passives (Italian)**

pro was broken the vase.
Patient

2) Observation

[26]/[27]



At first, (26) and (27) may appear to support Zobl's contention since in these examples the lack of a logical subject is indicated by the *be + en* structure, crucially, without NP movement involved. These examples, however, are immaterial to the lack-of-a-logical-subject account for 'passive' unaccusatives because they contain transitive verbs, not unaccusatives.

A crucial question for the validity of the lack-of-a-logical-subject analysis is, therefore, whether unaccusative verbs in IL English appear in the structural patterns of (25). If they do, we should find sentences such as (28). (In the subsequent examples, the NP *three boys* is used for consistency. The lack of a logical subject in these sentences becomes more evident if the argument is replaced by, say, *three packages*.)

28) * There/It/pro is/are arrived three boys at the station.

Notice, incidentally, that sentences comparable to (28) are grammatical in Italian and French:

29) Italian:	pro	sono	arrivati	tre ragazzi	alla stazione.
	explet	be 3pl	arrive p.p.	three boys	to-the station
30) French:	Il	est	arrivé	trois garçons	à la gare.
	explet	be 3sg	arrive p.p.	three boys	to the station

If the lack-of-a-logical-subject account is on the right track, therefore, sentences like (28) are expected to appear in IL English data (in particular, of native speakers of languages such as Italian and French).

Section 2 Previous studies

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

e. **Passives**

pro was broken the vase.
Patient

2) Observation

[26]/[27]

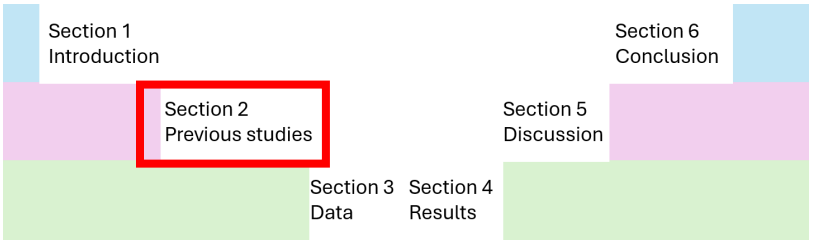
3) Limitation

Looking at a different construction.

4) Prediction

a. We could find an example like:
pro/it was arrived a man.

b. We won't get examples like:
pro/it arrived a man.



Furthermore, this analysis also predicts that the sole argument of an unaccusative verb will not normally appear postverbally without the nontarget *be* + *en*, as shown in (31):

31) a. There arrived three boys at the station.
b. * It arrived three boys at the station.
c. * pro arrived three boys at the station.

In (31a)–(31c), the NP arguments are in the object position with no logical subject expressed in the sentences. Nevertheless, the lack of a logical subject is not indicated with the *be* + *en*. Thus, such postverbal NP sentences would contradict Zobl's idea. Notice, however, that sentences like (31a) are grammatical in the target English and are thus potentially available in the input which learners encounter. If so, they may appear in IL English as a result of acquisition based on positive evidence. Therefore, the critical question for the lack-of-a-logical-subject analysis is whether sentences such as (31b)–(31c) often show up in L2 English.

Section 2 Previous studies

(Approach 4) Lack of Agent

(Logical subject)

Rule: Lack of AG ⇒ be + -en

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

e. **Passives**

pro was broken the vase.
Patient

2) Observation

[26]/[27]

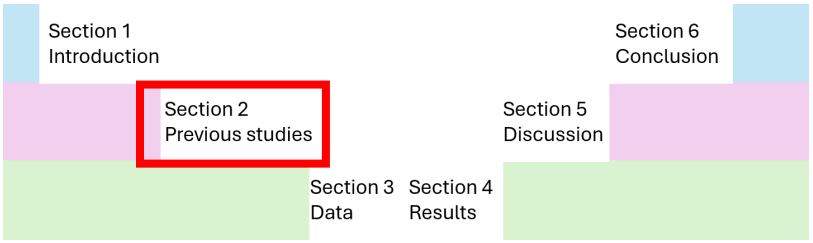
3) Limitation

Looking at a different construction.

4) Prediction

a. We could find an example like:
pro/it was arrived a man.

b. We won't get examples like:
pro/it arrived a man.



Furthermore, this analysis also predicts that the sole argument of an unaccusative verb will not normally appear postverbally without the nontarget *be* + *en*, as shown in (31):

31) a. There arrived three boys at the station.
b. * It arrived three boys at the station.
c. * pro arrived three boys at the station.

In (31a)–(31c), the NP arguments are in the object position with no logical subject expressed in the sentences. Nevertheless, the lack of a logical subject is not indicated with the *be* + *en*. Thus, such postverbal NP sentences would contradict Zobl's idea. Notice, however, that sentences like (31a) are grammatical in the target English and are thus potentially available in the input which learners encounter. If so, they may appear in IL English as a result of acquisition based on positive evidence. Therefore, the critical question for the lack-of-a-logical-subject analysis is whether sentences such as (31b)–(31c) often show up in L2 English.

28) * There/It/pro is/are arrived three boys at the station.

Section 2 Previous studies

(Approach 5) Influence of NP mvt

1) Proposal

a. **Transitives**

John broke **the vase**.
Agent Patient

Approach 5
NP movement,
so *be –en*.

Approach 4
No Agent,
so *be –en*.

d. **Passives**

The vase was broken.
Patient

2) Prediction

We never find an example like:

pro/it was arrived a man.

Function Words

Grammatical glue · CC IN TO RP

CC — Coordinating conjunction

e.g. &, 'n, and, both, but, either, et, for, less, minus, neither, nor, or, plus, so, therefore, times, versus, vs., whether, yet

```
Tea and coffee are hot .
NN  CC  NN     VBP JJ  .
```

IN — Preposition or subordinating conjunction

e.g. among, whether, inside, despite, on, by, throughout, below, within, for, towards, near, behind, atop, around, if, like, until, into, beside

```
I   sit at home if it  rains .
PRP VBP IN NN   IN PRP VBZ   .
```

TO — The word “to”

e.g. to (as preposition or infinitive marker)

```
I   want to go to Osaka .
PRP VBP  TO VB TO NNP   .
```

RP — Particle

e.g. aboard, about, across, along, apart, around, aside, at, away, back, behind, by, down, forth, in, off, on, out, over, through, under, up, upon, with

```
She picked up the phone .
PRP VBD    RP DT  NN    .
```

Special Words

Small word classes with their own tags · MD EX UH

MD — Modal

e.g. can, cannot, could, couldn't, dare, may, might, must, need, ought, shall, should, shouldn't, will, would

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
You can do it  .
PRP MD  VB PRP .
```

EX — Existential there

e.g. there

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
There is  a  cat on the roof .
EX    VBZ DT NN  IN DT  NN   .
```

UH — Interjection

e.g. Goodbye, Gosh, Wow, Jeepers, Hubba, Hey, Oops, amen, huh, howdy, uh, dammit, shucks, heck, golly, man, baby ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

```
Wow , that is  amazing !
UH  , DT   VBZ JJ      .
```

Non-standard Items

Foreign words, list markers and symbols · FW LS SYM

FW — Foreign word

e.g. gemeinschaft, hund, ich, jeux, habeas, Herr, vous, alai, je, jour, objets, fille, quibusdam, pas, trop, oui, corporis ...

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

She	whispered	carpe	diem	.
PRP	VBD	**FW**	**FW**	.

LS — List item marker

e.g. A, A., B, B., C, D, First, One, Second, Third, Two, a, b, c, d, first, five, four, one, six, three, two

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

a	)	Wash	the	rice	.
LS	)	VB	DT	NN	.

SYM — Symbol

e.g. %, &, *, +, <, =, >, @, U.S, U.S.S.R

EXAMPLE SENTENCE

2	+	3	=	5
CD	**SYM**	CD	**SYM**	CD

Punctuation

Sentence-level marks · , . : --

, **Comma**

e.g. ,

```
Yes , I   agree .
UH  , PRP VBP   .
```

. **Sentence-final punctuation**

e.g. .!?

```
Is  it  true ?
VBZ PRP JJ   .
```

: **Colon, semicolon, dash, ellipsis**

e.g. :; ...

```
I   have one goal : win .
PRP VBP  CD  NN   : VB  .
```

-- **Dash**

e.g. --

```
He  left -- quietly .
PRP VBD  -- RB      .
```

Symbols, Quotes & Brackets

In parsed trees, (and) appear as -LRB- and -RRB-

$ **Currency symbol**

e.g. $, -$, --$, A$, C$, HK$, M$, US$

```
It  costs $ 5  .
PRP VBZ   $ CD .
```

**Pound sign**

e.g. #

```
Room # 12 is  open .
NN   # CD VBZ JJ   .
```

`` **Opening quotation mark**

e.g. `, ``

```
He  said `` hi '' .
PRP VBD  `` UH '' .
```

'' **Closing quotation mark**

e.g. ', "

```
He  said `` hi '' .
PRP VBD  `` UH '' .
```

(**Opening bracket**

e.g. (, [, {

```
He  left ( early ) .
PRP VBD  ( RB    ) .
```

) **Closing bracket**

e.g.),], }

```
He  left ( early ) .
PRP VBD  ( RB    ) .
```

Practice 4

Function Words to Punctuation · Click to reveal the hidden words and their tags

1	Tom **and** Mary went **to** the park .	NNP **?** NNP VBD **?** DT NN .
2	You **must** turn **off** the light .	PRP **?** VB **?** DT NN .
3	**There** is a bird **in** the tree .	**?** VBZ DT NN **?** DT NN .
4	**Wow** , the cake costs $ 5 !	**?** **?** DT NN VBZ **?** CD **?**
5	She said `` **carpe diem** '' .	PRP VBD **?** **?** **?** **?** .
6	**a**) Add 2 **+** 3 .	**?** **?** VB CD **?** CD .

Assignments for the next session

1. Reading assignment, as usual.

2. Complete your POS tagging. Submit your file to KLMS.